

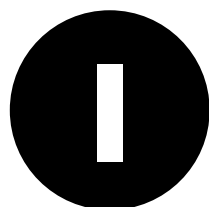
THE EV RUS

FUEL PRICE HIKES DURING THE WEST ASIA WAR, COUPLED WITH WIDER MODEL CHOICES AND BETTER CHARGING INFRASTRUCTURE, ARE ACCELERATING INDIA'S SHIFT TO ELECTRIC MOBILITY

BY KARAN DHAR



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INDIA'S ELECTRIC VEHICLE market appears to be nearing an inflection point as consumers shift faster from internal-combustion engine (ICE) vehicles to green mobility. Elevated fuel prices in the wake of the West Asia conflict, increasing product choices and expanding charging infrastructure are nudging price-sensitive buyers to look at EVs in a more serious manner.

The trend is visible in sales numbers. Electric car penetration hit record highs for three straight months through June—

6% in April, 7% in May and 8% in June. That marks a sharp jump from FY26, when EVs made up 4.2% of passenger vehicle sales, with 2,00,000 EVs sold out of total sales of 4.7 million.

India's largest electric carmaker, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, recorded a threefold jump in EV bookings recently. "There has been a significant increase in demand post the West Asia crisis. Bookings have jumped three times from January and a year ago," Shailesh Chandra, Managing Director and CEO of Tata